

Short title
and citation.

2. This Act may be cited as the British North America Act, 1951, and the British North America Acts, 1867 to 1949, and this Act may be cited together as the British North America Acts, 1867 to 1951.

CHAPTER 33

An Act to repeal the Witchcraft Act, 1735, and to make, in substitution for certain provisions of section four of the Vagrancy Act, 1824, express provision for the punishment of persons who fraudulently purport to act as spiritualistic mediums or to exercise powers of telepathy, clairvoyance or other similar powers.
[22nd June 1951.]

BE it enacted by the King's most Excellent Majesty, by and with the advice and consent of the Lords Spiritual and Temporal, and Commons, in this present Parliament assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:—

Punishment
of fraudulent
mediums, &c.

1.—(1) Subject to the provisions of this section, any person who—

(a) with intent to deceive purports to act as a spiritualistic medium or to exercise any powers of telepathy, clairvoyance or other similar powers, or

(b) in purporting to act as a spiritualistic medium or to exercise such powers as aforesaid, uses any fraudulent device,

shall be guilty of an offence.

(2) A person shall not be convicted of an offence under the foregoing subsection unless it is proved that he acted for reward; and for the purposes of this section a person shall be deemed to act for reward if any money is paid, or other valuable thing given, in respect of what he does, whether to him or to any other person.

(3) A person guilty of an offence under this section shall be liable on summary conviction to a fine not exceeding fifty pounds or to imprisonment for a term not exceeding four months or to both such fine and such imprisonment, or on conviction on indictment to a fine not exceeding five hundred pounds or to imprisonment for a term not exceeding two years or to both such fine and such imprisonment.

(4) No proceedings for an offence under this section shall be brought in England or Wales except by or with the consent of the Director of Public Prosecutions.

(5) Nothing in subsection (1) of this section shall apply to anything done solely for the purpose of entertainment.

2. The following enactments are hereby repealed, that is to say—

(a) the Witchcraft Act, 1735, so far as still in force, and 9 Geo. 2. c. 5.

(b) section four of the Vagrancy Act, 1824, so far as it extends to persons purporting to act as spiritualistic mediums or to exercise any powers of telepathy, clairvoyance or other similar powers, or to persons who, in purporting so to act or to exercise such powers, use fraudulent devices. 5 Geo. 4. c. 83.

3.—(1) This Act may be cited as the Fraudulent Mediums Act, 1951. Short title
and extent.

(2) This Act shall not extend to Northern Ireland.

CHAPTER 34

National Insurance Act, 1951

ARRANGEMENT OF SECTIONS

Section

1. Alteration of Exchequer contributions to National Insurance Fund.
2. Widows' benefit.
3. Increase of benefit for children.
4. Retirement pensions.
5. Increased guardian's allowance.
6. Relaxation of conditions for increase of benefit in respect of wife engaged in gainful occupation.
7. Re-entry into regular employment after retirement.
8. Appointed day, and supplementary provisions.
9. Regulations and orders.
10. Short title, citation and construction.

SCHEDULE.—Amendments consequential on the payment of benefit in respect of children other than the elder or eldest.
